

RECORDING 1: Joining the Riverside Community Centre

TRANSCRIPT:

WOMAN: Good morning, Riverside Community Centre, Amelia speaking.

MAN: Oh, good morning. I've just moved into the area and I'd like to join the centre, if that's still possible?

WOMAN: Of course. Let me take a few details and I'll set up a membership record for you. Can I start with your full name?

MAN: Yes, it's Daniel Whitcombe.

WOMAN: Could you spell the surname for me?

MAN: W-H-I-T-C-O-M-B-E.

WOMAN: Whitcombe, thank you. And your address?

MAN: It's 42 Bramley Road. That's B-R-A-M-L-E-Y.

WOMAN: Bramley Road, lovely. That's the road behind the old station, isn't it?

MAN: That's the one, yes.

WOMAN: And a contact number?

MAN: My mobile is 0784 220 9163.

WOMAN: Let me read that back: 0784 220 9163.

MAN: Perfect.

WOMAN: Now, we offer three kinds of membership. There's standard, which is thirty pounds a year; family, which is fifty; and concession, which is eighteen and is for students and people over sixty-five. Which would suit you?

MAN: I'm a full-time student, so the concession one, please.

WOMAN: Right, concession it is. I will need to see your student card when you come in, just the once. Now, which activities are you interested in? That helps us send you the right newsletter.

MAN: I'd really like to do something with swimming. Is the pool open in the mornings?

WOMAN: It is, from half past six. And there's an adult swimming club on Tuesday evenings if you'd like something more structured.

MAN: I might, but let's put swimming down for now.

WOMAN: Swimming, noted. And how did you hear about us? We ask everybody.

MAN: A neighbour mentioned it, actually. She swims here every week.

WOMAN: Lovely, I'll put neighbour. Now, one last thing — is there anything we should know for safety reasons? Any medical condition?

MAN: I have asthma. It's very well controlled, but I do carry an inhaler.

WOMAN: That's useful for us to know, thank you. I'll note asthma on your record. Your membership will start on the first of March, and your card will be ready to collect from the reception desk after that date. There's a small charge for a replacement card, so do look after it.

MAN: Understood. Do I pay today?

WOMAN: You can pay when you collect the card. Oh, and do bring a padlock — the lockers in the changing rooms don't have keys.

MAN: A padlock. Right, I'll remember that.

INSTRUCTION: Questions 1-10. Complete the membership form below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Surname:

ANSWER: Whitcombe

2. Address: 42 Road

ANSWER: Bramley

3. Mobile number: 0784 220

ANSWER: 9163

4. Type of membership:

ANSWER: concession

5. Cost of membership per year: £

ANSWER: 18|eighteen

6. Document to bring on the first visit: a card

ANSWER: student

7. Main activity of interest:

ANSWER: swimming

8. Pool opens each morning at

ANSWER: 6.30|6:30|half past six

9. Heard about the centre from a

ANSWER: neighbour|neighbor

10. Medical condition recorded:

ANSWER: asthma

RECORDING 2: Volunteering at Kingsley City Farm

TRANSCRIPT:

VOICES: narrator=female

Good evening, everyone, and thank you for giving up your Thursday to come and hear about volunteering at Kingsley City Farm.

Let me start with what the farm actually is, because people often arrive expecting a petting zoo.

Kingsley was set up in 1978 on land that had been a coal yard, and the original purpose was not to entertain children but to give people in the surrounding streets somewhere to grow food. The animals came later, in the mid-eighties, and although they are now what most visitors photograph, the growing beds are still the heart of the place.

We currently have about ninety volunteers on the books, and roughly thirty of those come in every week. What we need most at the moment is not more people at weekends — Saturdays are, frankly, crowded — but people who can give us a weekday morning. Tuesday and Wednesday mornings are when the deliveries arrive and when almost all the maintenance gets done.

Now, the roles. Animal care is the one everybody asks about, and I should be honest with you: it is the hardest to get into, because volunteers who start there tend to stay for years. Gardening is where we always have space, and it is also, I would argue, where you will learn the most. Then there's the shop, the café, and school visits. School visits need people who are comfortable talking to a group of thirty seven-year-olds, which is a particular skill.

Everybody, whatever their role, does the same half-day induction. You cannot start without it. It covers handwashing, what to do if a child is hurt, and where the fire assembly point is. We run it on the first Saturday of each month.

A few practical things. Wear boots you don't mind ruining. We provide gloves, but not footwear. Do not bring food onto the site for the animals — well-meaning visitors have made several of our goats seriously ill this way. And if you are going to be absent, please tell us the day before, because on a weekday morning we may only have four people on site and losing one of them changes what we can do.

Finally, the thing nobody expects me to say: the reason most volunteers leave is not the weather and not the mud. It is that they took on too much at the start. Begin with one session a fortnight. You can always add more.

INSTRUCTION: Questions 11-20. Listen to the talk for new volunteers and answer the questions below.

11. What was the original purpose of the farm when it opened?

- A. To keep rare breeds of farm animal
- B. To give local people space to grow food
- C. To provide a play area for young children
- D. To teach farming skills to school groups

ANSWER: B

12. When does the farm most need extra volunteers?

- A. Saturday afternoons
- B. Sunday mornings
- C. Weekday mornings
- D. Weekday evenings

ANSWER: C

13. Which role does the speaker say is hardest to obtain?

- A. Animal care
- B. Gardening
- C. Working in the shop
- D. School visits

ANSWER: A

14. What advice does the speaker give at the end of the talk?

- A. Choose a role before the induction
- B. Avoid working outdoors in winter
- C. Start with a small commitment
- D. Volunteer with a friend

ANSWER: C

INSTRUCTION: Questions 15-20. Complete the notes below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

15. The farm was established in the year

ANSWER: 1978

16. Number of volunteers currently registered:

ANSWER: 90|ninety

17. All volunteers must complete a half-day before starting.

ANSWER: induction

18. The training is held on the first of every month.

ANSWER: Saturday

19. Volunteers must supply their own

ANSWER: boots|footwear

20. Visitors must never bring for the animals.

ANSWER: food

RECORDING 3: A tutorial about a field study

TRANSCRIPT:

VOICES: TUTOR=male, PRIYA=female, MARCUS=male

TUTOR: Right, Priya, Marcus — how is the river study coming along?

PRIYA: Better than last week. We've settled on the Elder Brook rather than the Calder, because the Calder has three sewage outflows on it and we'd never be able to say what was causing what.

TUTOR: That's sound reasoning. Fewer variables. And what exactly are you measuring?

MARCUS: Three things at each site: water temperature, dissolved oxygen, and the number of invertebrate species.

TUTOR: And the third of those is the interesting one, isn't it? Why?

MARCUS: Because it's the only one that tells you about the last few months rather than the last few hours. Temperature and oxygen change between morning and afternoon. The invertebrates are a record.

TUTOR: Exactly. Now, how many sites?

PRIYA: We had planned twelve, but we've cut it to eight. We realised that twelve sites done badly is worth less than eight done properly.

TUTOR: I agree, and I would have said so if you hadn't. Eight is enough for the statistics you'll want to run. What's your sampling method?

PRIYA: Kick sampling, three minutes at each site, same person doing it every time.

TUTOR: Good — the same person is important, and students always forget it. Now, the part I want to press you on. What is your control?

MARCUS: We're using the stretch above the farm as the control, because nothing enters the water upstream of it.

TUTOR: Are you sure? Have either of you actually walked that stretch?

PRIYA: Not all of it, no.

TUTOR: Then that's your next job, before you collect a single sample. I have seen three projects fail in the same way: a control site that turned out to have a drain in it. Walk the whole stretch, photograph anything that enters the water, and only then decide.

MARCUS: And the write-up — how long should the method section be?

TUTOR: Long enough that somebody else could repeat exactly what you did, and no longer. Most people write too much there and too little in the discussion. Aim for a thousand words on method, and remember the deadline is the fourteenth of May — that's a Friday, and the office closes at four.

INSTRUCTION: Questions 21-30. Listen to the discussion between two students and their tutor, and answer the questions below.

21. Why did the students choose the Elder Brook?

A. It is closer to the university

- B. It has fewer sources of pollution
- C. It has been studied before
- D. It is easier to walk along

ANSWER: B

22. According to Marcus, why is the invertebrate count especially useful?

- A. It is the quickest measurement to take
- B. It requires no special equipment
- C. It reflects conditions over a long period
- D. It can be checked by other students

ANSWER: C

23. Why did the students reduce the number of sites?

- A. They ran out of equipment
- B. The tutor instructed them to
- C. Some sites were unsafe
- D. They preferred fewer sites done well

ANSWER: D

24. What does the tutor insist the students do next?

- A. Inspect the whole control stretch on foot
- B. Repeat their first set of samples
- C. Change their sampling method
- D. Contact the farm owner

ANSWER: A

25. What does the tutor say about most students' reports?

- A. The method section is too short
- B. The discussion section is too long
- C. The method section is too long
- D. The results are poorly presented

ANSWER: C

INSTRUCTION: Questions 26-30. Complete the sentences below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

26. The students will collect data at sites.

ANSWER: 8|eight

27. Besides temperature and invertebrates, they will measure dissolved

ANSWER: oxygen

28. Their sampling technique is called sampling.

ANSWER: kick

29. The method section should be about words long.

ANSWER: 1000|1,000|a thousand

30. The project must be handed in by May.

ANSWER: 14|14th|the 14th|fourteenth

RECORDING 4: Urban heat islands

TRANSCRIPT:

VOICES: narrator=male

Good afternoon. Today I want to talk about a phenomenon that most of you have felt without naming: the urban heat island.

The term describes the simple observation that a city is warmer than the countryside around it. The difference is not trivial. On a still, clear night, the centre of a large city can be seven degrees warmer than farmland twelve kilometres away. And note that I said night. During the day the difference is often small; it is after sunset that the gap opens, because the city is not so much heating up faster as cooling down more slowly.

Why? Three reasons, and I want you to be able to separate them.

The first is materials. Concrete, brick and asphalt are dense, and dense materials store heat. A field radiates its warmth away within an hour or two of sunset. A street of buildings releases it

all night.

The second is geometry. A narrow street between tall buildings is what climatologists call an urban canyon, and it behaves like one: heat radiating from a wall does not escape to the sky, it simply strikes the wall opposite. The narrower the street, the less sky each surface can see, and the more slowly it cools.

The third is that cities produce heat of their own — from engines, from air conditioning, from bodies. In dense districts this can be a surprisingly large share of the total.

And there is a fourth factor that works by absence rather than presence: vegetation. A tree does not merely provide shade. It also cools the air by transpiration, moving water from soil to leaf to atmosphere, and that transfer takes energy. Replace grass with tarmac and you remove that cooling entirely.

Now, why does this matter beyond comfort? Heat is the deadliest weather hazard in most temperate countries, more so than storms or floods, and the deaths are concentrated at night. A body recovers from daytime heat while asleep — unless the bedroom does not cool. That is the mechanism by which the heat island kills.

What can be done? Three approaches, in ascending order of usefulness. Painting roofs a lighter colour raises reflectivity, and it works, though it does nothing at street level. Green roofs are better, but they are heavy and most existing buildings cannot take one. The measure with the strongest evidence behind it is also the oldest: planting street trees. A mature canopy over a residential street reduces the surface temperature of the road beneath it by up to twelve degrees, and it does so at a cost that any city can afford.

INSTRUCTION: Questions 31-40. Complete the lecture notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

31. At night a large city centre may be up to degrees warmer than nearby farmland.

ANSWER: seven|7

32. The temperature gap is greatest after

ANSWER: sunset

33. Building materials such as concrete and asphalt are able to heat.

ANSWER: store

34. A narrow street between tall buildings is known as an urban

ANSWER: canyon

35. The narrower the street, the less each surface can see.

ANSWER: sky

36. Cities also generate their own heat from engines, air conditioning and

ANSWER: bodies

37. Trees cool the air by shade and by

ANSWER: transpiration

38. Heat deaths are concentrated during the

ANSWER: night

39. Lighter roofs work by increasing a building's

ANSWER: reflectivity

40. The measure with the strongest supporting evidence is planting street

ANSWER: trees